

A collage of various contraceptive methods. In the top left, there's a blister pack of yellow birth control pills. Below it, a blue and white condom is visible. To the right, a red diaphragm is shown. In the bottom left, another blister pack of yellow and white pills is visible. A clear plastic condom wrapper is in the center. A white condom is partially visible in the bottom left corner. The background is a mix of these items, creating a collage effect.

CONTRACEPTION

NURS 280 MAY 26, 2026



MECHANISMS OF BIRTH CONTROL

- **Hormonal** methods of birth control prevent pregnancy by stopping ovulation
- **Barrier** methods of birth control keep the sperm away from the egg
- **“Natural”** methods of birth control make use of the rules of conception to reduce the odds of the sperm and egg meeting
- **Emergency** methods of birth control interrupt conception when it is likely to happen



METHODS OF BIRTH CONTROL AVAILABLE IN CANADA

HORMONAL

Pill

Patch (Evra)

Ring (NuvaRing)

Injection (Depo)

Implant (Nexplanon)

EMERGENCY

Plan B (levonorgestrel)

ella (ulipristal)

IUDs

BARRIER

External condom

Internal condom

IUDs

“NATURAL”

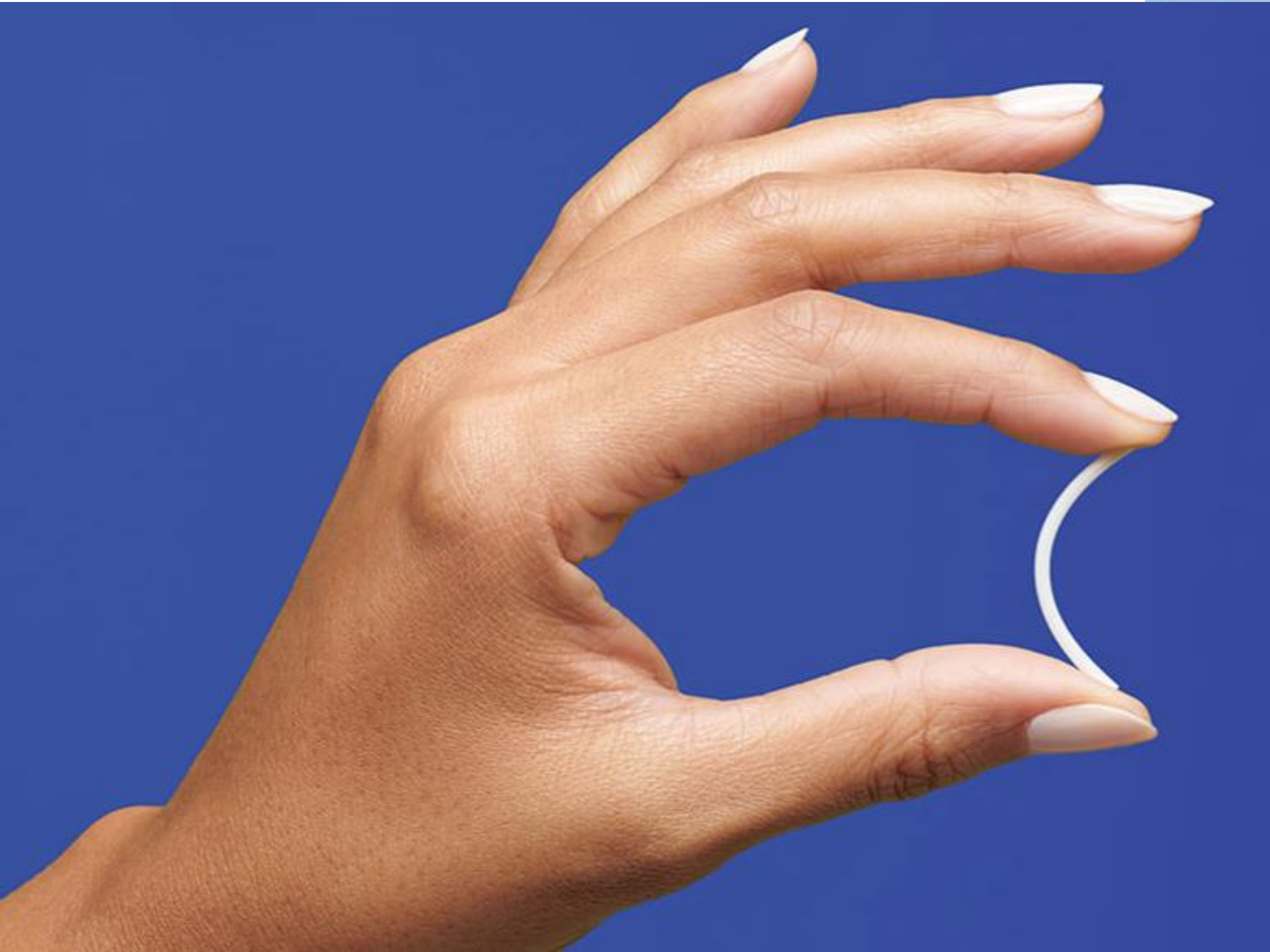
Abstinence

Withdrawal

Sympto-thermal method

Lactational amenorrhea





Free contraceptives

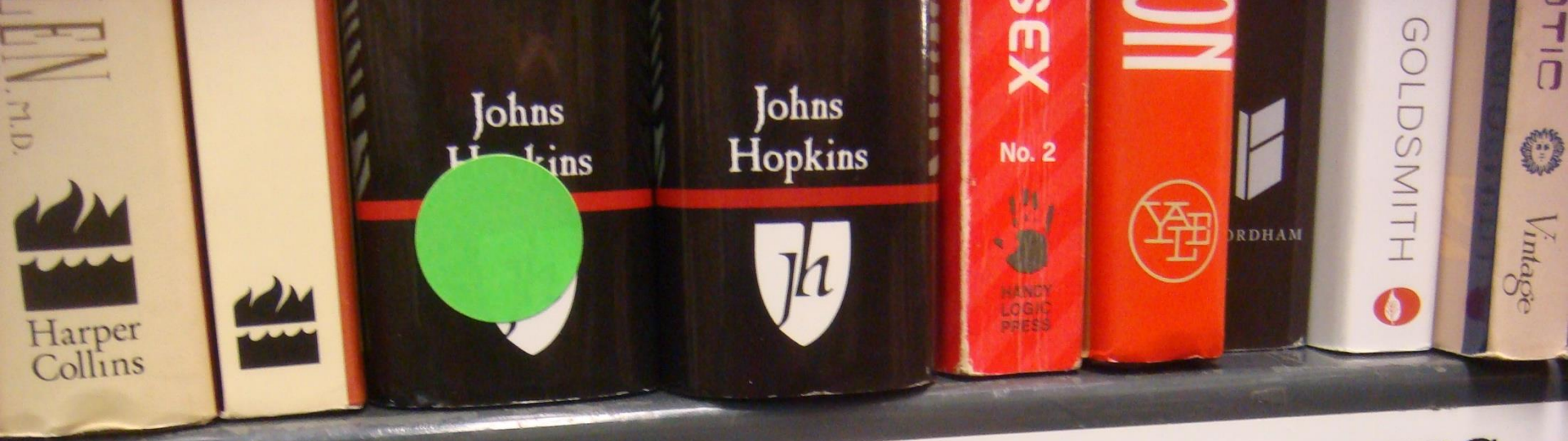
PharmaCare pays for these prescription contraceptives for any B.C. resident:

- Most prescription contraceptive pills
- Intrauterine devices (IUDs) – hormonal and copper
- Hormonal implant
- Hormonal vaginal ring
- Contraceptive injection
- Emergency contraception (no prescription needed)

To get free contraceptives, you need to be enrolled in the [BC Medical Services Plan \(MSP\)](#). If you have applied and your MSP coverage is not yet active, a pharmacist can help you get exceptional coverage.

Contraceptives are also covered for non-contraceptive use.

From: <https://www2.gov.bc.ca/gov/content/health/health-drug-coverage/pharmacare-for-bc-residents/what-we-cover/prescription-contraceptives>



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